



ROOTING AND CUSTOM ROMS FOR ANDROID

Android is the underlying software that powers a major chunk of all smartphones in the world. Built from ground up by the Open Handset Alliance led by Google, Android was intended to be an open source operating system for mobile devices. This open nature of the platform gave handset manufacturers almost limitless flexibility in the software and allowed them to differentiate their products from each other. Soon OEMs came up with their own take on the OS. (This is why devices from different manufacturers sport a very different look and feel, even though they all run Android). While this meant OEMs (and even carriers) could load the device with their own custom apps and interface tweaks, it also meant that OEMs could place several restrictions on the device, often to protect their own business interests.